MODULE 6

Weather Wise

"We'll weather the weather whatever the weather, whether we like it or not."

— ANONYMOUS

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How does weather affect us?

MAIN STORIES

1	**Wild Weather** · Thomas Kingsley Troupe	NARRATIVE NONFICTION
2	**Cloudette** · Tom Lichtenheld	FANTASY
3	**Get Ready for Weather** · Lucy Jones	INFORMATIONAL
4	**Whatever the Weather** · A Collection of Poems	POETRY

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NAME _____ DATE _____

Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 6 · Weather Wise · Grade 2 · 27 Items

CCSS L.2.4 · L.2.5 · L.2.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.2.6

climate

The **climate** of a place is —

- ○ **A.** the weather outside on just one day.
- ○ **B.** the name of one storm.
- ○ **C.** how hot or cold it feels right now.
- ○ **D.** the normal weather of that place.

Q2 L.2.6

precipitation

Precipitation is —

- ○ **A.** a kind of cloud.
- ○ **B.** water that falls from the sky — rain, sleet, hail, or snow.
- ○ **C.** wind that blows hard.
- ○ **D.** a hot summer day.

Q3 L.2.6

temperature

Temperature tells us —

- ○ **A.** how loud the thunder is.
- ○ **B.** the color of the sky.
- ○ **C.** how hot or cold a place is.
- ○ **D.** the size of a cloud.

Q4 L.2.4

tough

"This wind is making flying **tough**." Here, **tough** means —

- A. very tasty.
- B. easy and quick.
- C. warm and sunny.
- D. hard to do.

Q5 L.2.4

predict

Meteorologists study patterns to **predict** weather. To **predict** is to —

- A. tell what already happened in the past.
- B. tell what is happening right now.
- C. say what will probably happen next.
- D. watch the clouds change shape.

Q6 L.2.4

pellets

The rain froze into ice **pellets**. **Pellets** are —

- A. warm pools of water.
- B. long, flat strips.
- C. soft, fluffy clouds.
- D. small, round balls of something.

Q7 L.2.5 TRAP

clings

"The ice crystal **clings** to other crystals." Here, **clings** means —

- A. floats far away from.
- B. melts into.
- C. sticks tightly to.
- D. jumps over.

Q8 L.2.4

funnel

A tornado is a **funnel** of wind. A **funnel** is —

- A. a flat circle of clouds.
- B. a shape that is wide at the top and narrow at the bottom.
- C. a long, straight line.
- D. a round shape that is the same all the way around.

Q9 L.2.4

occur

Tornadoes **occur** over flat land. To **occur** is to —

- A. stop or end.
- B. become quiet.
- C. happen or take place.
- D. grow taller.

Q10 L.2.5 TRAP

excess

After heavy rain, the ground has **excess** water. Here, **excess** means —

- A. very dry.
- B. a way out (like an "exit").
- C. more than is needed — too much.
- D. a kind of road.

Q11 L.2.4

damage

High winds and heavy rain can **damage** buildings. **Damage** means —

- A. make something bigger.
- B. fix something that is broken.
- C. wash something clean.
- D. hurt or break something.

POWER WORDS · CLOUDETTE

Q12 L.2.4

average

Cloudette was smaller than the **average** cloud. **Average** means —

- ○ **A.** the biggest of all.
- ○ **B.** the smallest of all.
- ○ **C.** usual or typical — not big and not small.
- ○ **D.** very strange and unusual.

Q13 L.2.4

advantages

"Being small had lots of **advantages**." **Advantages** are —

- ○ **A.** hard parts that slow you down.
- ○ **B.** problems that get in the way.
- ○ **C.** things you must give away.
- ○ **D.** good things that help you.

Q14 L.2.5 TRAP

front

A weather **front** brings a change in weather. Here, **front** means —

- ○ **A.** the part that is "in front of" your house.
- ○ **B.** the edge where two kinds of air meet.
- ○ **C.** the back of a car.
- ○ **D.** the first person at the front of a line.

POWER WORDS · CLOUDETTE (CONTINUED)

Q15 L.2.4

impressed

"Even the higher-ups were **impressed**." **Impressed** means —

- ○ **A.** bored and not interested.
- ○ **B.** upset and crying.
- ○ **C.** filled with admiration — thought it was very good.
- ○ **D.** surprised in a scared, worried way.

POWER WORDS · GET READY FOR WEATHER

Q16 L.2.4

gusts

"Winds can be strong **gusts** or soft breezes." **Gusts** are —

- **A.** still, calm air with no wind.
- **B.** very small clouds.
- **C.** drops of rain.
- **D.** sudden, strong puffs of wind.

Q17 L.2.5 TRAP

flash

"The bright **flash** of lightning." Here, **flash** means —

- **A.** a tool you use in the dark (a flashlight).
- **B.** a sudden burst of bright light.
- **C.** running very fast.
- **D.** a quick, short moment of time.

Q18 L.2.4

supplies

People bring clothing and **supplies** they may need. **Supplies** are —

- **A.** fun toys people do not really need.
- **B.** old things people throw away.
- **C.** things people need and use, like food or tools.
- **D.** places people go to stay warm.

Q19 L.2.5 TRAP

layer

Wearing more than one **layer** keeps you warm. Here, a **layer** is —

- **A.** a person who works in law (a "lawyer").
- **B.** one of the things stacked one on top of another.
- **C.** a hen that lays eggs.
- **D.** a person who tells lies (a "liar").

Q20 L.2.4

splatter

In the poem "Weather," the word **splatter** means —

- ○ **A.** a soft, quiet, silent hush.
- ○ **B.** the sound of drops splashing and scattering.
- ○ **C.** a high, sweet whistle.
- ○ **D.** a dry, dusty crackle.

Q21 L.2.4

rumble

In the poem "Weather," the word **rumble** means —

- ○ **A.** a high, sweet whistle.
- ○ **B.** a low, rolling sound — like thunder.
- ○ **C.** a quick, sharp bell.
- ○ **D.** a quiet wave on a beach.

Q22 L.2.5 TRAP

slather

What does the word **slather** mean?

- ○ **A.** spread thickly over something.
- ○ **B.** slide along low, like a snake.
- ○ **C.** twist into a tight knot.
- ○ **D.** hold still and not move.

Q23 L.2.4

glide

To **glide** is to —

- ○ **A.** jump up and down.
- ○ **B.** stop suddenly.
- ○ **C.** move smoothly and easily through the air or water.
- ○ **D.** dig deep into the ground.

Q24 L.2.5 TRAP

covers

"Clouds **cover** the sky. Nighttime **covers**. Blankets **cover** me." Here, **covers** means —

- ○ **A.** the front pages of books.
- ○ **B.** sings a new song.
- ○ **C.** spreads over the top of something so you can't see it.
- ○ **D.** the money you pay to get in.

Q25 L.2.4

creep

In the poem, the cloud dragons **creep** across the sky. To **creep** is to —

- ○ **A.** move slowly and quietly.
- ○ **B.** shout loudly.
- ○ **C.** jump high and fast.
- ○ **D.** melt away.

Q26 L.2.5 TRAP

slithering

The cloud dragons go **slithering** across the sky. **Slithering** means —

- ○ **A.** standing very still.
- ○ **B.** rolling like a ball.
- ○ **C.** sliding smoothly like a snake.
- ○ **D.** hopping up and down.

Q27 L.2.4

shimmering

The clouds were **shimmering** in the sun. **Shimmering** means —

- ○ **A.** shining with a soft, wavy light.
- ○ **B.** turning dark gray.
- ○ **C.** sinking down low.
- ○ **D.** staying dry.

B Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 6 · Weather Wise · Grade 2

CCSS RL.2.1 – RL.2.7 / RI.2.1 – RI.2.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

Story 1 · Wild Weather

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · THOMAS KINGSLEY TROUPE · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.2.1

Who is Sonny at the start of the story?

- ○ **A.** A meteorologist on TV.
- ○ **B.** A paper (origami) bird made by a hiker.
- ○ **C.** A real eagle.
- ○ **D.** A cloud in the sky.

Q2 RI.2.3

Why does Chuck want to leave?

- ○ **A.** He wants to find a new mountain.
- ○ **B.** He wants to fly to the moon.
- ○ **C.** He is tired of meeting Sonny.
- ○ **D.** He wants to find his wife, Natasha, who is missing.

Q3 RI.2.3

How does Chuck describe a hailstorm to Sonny?

- ○ **A.** Soft drops of warm water.
- ○ **B.** A cloud that puts you to sleep.
- ○ **C.** Pellets — small, hard pieces of ice that hit hard.
- ○ **D.** A long, gentle rain.

Q4 RI.2.3

How does Chuck say a snowflake is made?

- **A.** It is painted by a meteorologist.
- **B.** One ice crystal clings to other ice crystals until they form a snowflake.
- **C.** A raindrop turns into a bird.
- **D.** Wind blows snow off a roof.

Q5 RI.2.8

The author makes the point that hurricanes and tornadoes are alike. Which reason from the text best supports that point?

- **A.** Both of them form over the ocean in the summer.
- **B.** Both of them bring deep snow and hard ice pellets.
- **C.** Both of them have strong winds that spin around fast.
- **D.** Both of them stay in one quiet spot and do not move.

Q6 RI.2.6

What does the author mainly want to explain in the part of "Wild Weather" about tornadoes and hurricanes?

- **A.** What these wild storms are and how they form.
- **B.** Which storm is the most beautiful to watch.
- **C.** How to fold a paper bird like Sonny.
- **D.** Why ducks make the best weather guides.

Q7 RI.2.5

"Wild Weather" is Narrative Nonfiction. What makes it nonfiction?

- **A.** It rhymes like a song.
- **B.** It tells true facts about weather inside a story.
- **C.** It only uses pictures.
- **D.** It is made up entirely.

Q8 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Wild Weather"?

- ○ **A.** Hikers should always fly paper birds to stay safe in a storm.
- ○ **B.** Ducks teach people what causes wind and hail.
- ○ **C.** Earth has many wild storms, and meteorologists help us predict them.
- ○ **D.** Tornadoes form mostly over the warm ocean, just like hurricanes.

Story 2 · Cloudette

FANTASY · TOM LICHTENHELD · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.2.5

What kind of text is "Cloudette"?

- ○ **A.** A fantasy — clouds with feelings and names are not real.
- ○ **B.** A biography of a real cloud.
- ○ **C.** A weather report on the news.
- ○ **D.** A how-to book about clouds.

Q10 RL.2.1

How is Cloudette different from the other clouds?

- ○ **A.** She is colder than other clouds.
- ○ **B.** She is smaller than the average cloud.
- ○ **C.** She is brighter than the sun.
- ○ **D.** She is the loudest cloud.

Q11 RL.2.3

At first, how does Cloudette feel about being small?

- ○ **A.** She tries to grow bigger right away.
- ○ **B.** She is angry every day.
- ○ **C.** She wants to disappear.
- ○ **D.** She does not mind — being small has lots of advantages.

Q12 RL.2.3

Why does Cloudette start feeling blue?

- **A.** She wants to do big, important things, but she is too small.
- **B.** She lost her friend the kite.
- **C.** She got too cold.
- **D.** The other clouds laughed at her name.

Q13 RL.2.3

What happens to Cloudette during the big storm?

- **A.** The wind carries her to a new place where she does not know anyone.
- **B.** She melts into a small puddle.
- **C.** She becomes invisible.
- **D.** She stays exactly where she was.

Q14 RL.2.3

What "big, important thing" does Cloudette finally do?

- **A.** She moves a mountain.
- **B.** She makes a snowman.
- **C.** She blocks out the sun for a week.
- **D.** She rains on a dried-up pond to fill it for the frog.

Q15 RL.2.3

How does Cloudette feel at the end?

- **A.** Tired but happy — and even the higher-ups are impressed.
- **B.** Angry that no one noticed.
- **C.** Wanting to do the same thing again right away.
- **D.** Lonely and lost.

Q16 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Cloudette"?

- **A.** A small cloud can never make real rain, no matter how hard it tries.
- **B.** Cloudette wants to leave her new neighborhood.
- **C.** Even something small can do something big and important when it cares.
- **D.** Only the big "higher-up" clouds do important work.

Story 3 · Get Ready for Weather

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · LUCY JONES · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.2.5

What kind of text is "Get Ready for Weather"?

- **A.** A long fairy tale.
- **B.** Informational text — it gives facts and tips for real life.
- **C.** A rhyming poem.
- **D.** A diary written by a cloud.

Q18 RI.2.2

What is the main topic of "Get Ready for Weather"?

- **A.** A list that names every cloud in the sky.
- **B.** The life story of one busy meteorologist.
- **C.** How to get ready for different kinds of weather.
- **D.** How a small cloud learns to make rain fall.

Q19 RI.2.8

The author tells readers to go inside as soon as they hear thunder. Which reason from the text best supports this advice?

- **A.** Lightning in a thunderstorm can be very dangerous.
- **B.** A pretty rainbow often shows up after the rain.
- **C.** Deep snow can pile up and cover all the roads.
- **D.** Blowing sand can get into your eyes and nose.

Q20 RI.2.6

Why does the author include a "Blizzard Shopping" box about buying batteries, flashlights, food, and water?

- **A.** To tell a long story about one family's snow day.
- **B.** To explain the way that snowflakes are made.
- **C.** To show readers how to get ready before a blizzard.
- **D.** To list the price of each food item at the store.

Q21 RI.2.3

When does the text say a sandstorm happens?

- ○ **A.** When it snows heavily.
- ○ **B.** When strong winds pick up sand — and being outside in one is unsafe.
- ○ **C.** When the air is very still.
- ○ **D.** When clouds turn pink at sunset.

Q22 RI.2.3

Why does the author tell us to bring clothing and supplies?

- ○ **A.** So our clothes match the colors of the season.
- ○ **B.** So meteorologists can study what we wear.
- ○ **C.** So we will not get wet even on sunny days.
- ○ **D.** So we are ready for the kind of weather we will be in.

Q23 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did Lucy Jones write this text?

- ○ **A.** To share a story about meteorologists at work.
- ○ **B.** To teach readers how to become meteorologists.
- ○ **C.** To list every kind of cloud in order.
- ○ **D.** To explain storms and how to stay safe.

Q24 RI.2.5

"Get Ready for Weather" is organized by different KINDS of storms (thunderstorms, blizzards, sandstorms, hurricanes). How does this text structure HELP the reader?

- ○ **A.** It groups facts by storm type so readers can find information about each one easily.
- ○ **B.** It tells one family's story from the start of a storm to the end.
- ○ **C.** It lists every storm in the order it happened in history.
- ○ **D.** It explains storms only through poems and short rhymes.

Story 4 · Whatever the Weather

POETRY · A COLLECTION OF POEMS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.2.5

"Whatever the Weather" is —

- ○ **A.** A long informational chapter.
- ○ **B.** A collection of poems about weather.
- ○ **C.** A drama with character lines.
- ○ **D.** A how-to guide.

Q26 RL.2.4

In Eve Merriam's "Weather," the poet uses sound words like *splatter* and *rumble*. These words mostly help the reader —

- ○ **A.** See a sunny field.
- ○ **B.** Count the number of clouds.
- ○ **C.** Smell a fresh pie.
- ○ **D.** Hear the sounds of a rainstorm beginning.

Q27 RL.2.4

In "Cloud Dragons," the dragons "curl their tails as they go **slithering** by." Words like *slither* and *glide* are —

- ○ **A.** Numbers.
- ○ **B.** Words that show smooth, sliding movement.
- ○ **C.** Names of clouds.
- ○ **D.** Days of the week.

Q28 RL.2.5

Nikki Giovanni's "Covers" repeats the word "cover" line after line. How does this REPETITION shape the poem?

- ○ **A.** It makes the poem sound like a question-and-answer game between two speakers.
- ○ **B.** It turns the poem into a shopping list of things to buy at the store.
- ○ **C.** It gives the poem a clear beginning, middle, and end like a story.
- ○ **D.** It links the lines together by using the same word to connect sky, night, and a child in bed.

Q29 RL.2.5

In a poem, words that sound like what they mean (splatter, rumble) are called —

- **A.** Story words only.
- **B.** Number words.
- **C.** Title words.
- **D.** Sound words (onomatopoeia) — words that copy a real sound.

Q30 RL.2.4

In "Cloud Dragons," the cloud dragons "creep" and go "slithering." This makes us picture clouds that —

- **A.** Stand perfectly still.
- **B.** Bounce like balls.
- **C.** Disappear in a flash.
- **D.** Move slowly and smoothly across the sky, like long animals.

Q31 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Whatever the Weather"?

- **A.** Rainy weather is the only weather poets enjoy writing about.
- **B.** Each kind of weather has its own sound and feeling, and poets help us notice.
- **C.** A poem must use rhyme on every single line.
- **D.** Cloud dragons are real animals that live in the sky.

Q32 RL.2.9

How is "Whatever the Weather" DIFFERENT from "Get Ready for Weather"?

- **A.** Both rhyme on every line and never share any facts at all.
- **B.** Both are how-to guides that teach the very same steps.
- **C.** Both are biographies that tell the life story of one meteorologist.
- **D.** One is poems about feelings and sounds; the other gives facts and safety tips.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 6 · Weather Wise · Grade 2

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply about weather. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Causation DOK 3

In **"Wild Weather,"** Chuck explains how a snowflake is made — step by step. Show the cause-and-effect chain that turns water vapor into a snowflake.

FROM WATER VAPOR TO SNOWFLAKE

CAUSE · WHAT STARTS IN THE AIR	→	EFFECT · WHAT FALLS FROM THE SKY

What does this teach us about how weather REALLY happens?

Q2 Change DOK 2

In **"Cloudette,"** Cloudette changes from "small and feeling blue" to "tired but happy." Track her change.

CLOUDETTE · BEFORE & AFTER

BEFORE THE STORM	AFTER HELPING THE FROG

What ONE thing changed how Cloudette felt about herself?

Q3 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Get Ready for Weather,"** Lucy Jones names FOUR storms and how to stay safe. Fill in the web with four storms — and one safety tip for each.

FOUR STORMS · ONE SAFETY TIP EACH

Stay Safe in...

STORM 1 + TIP

STORM 2 + TIP

STORM 3 + TIP

STORM 4 + TIP

Which storm is hardest to prepare for? Why?

Q4 Connection DOK 3

In **"Whatever the Weather,"** poets use sound words and pictures to make weather come alive. Compare TWO poems — what the poet sees, hears, and feels.

TWO POEMS · THREE SENSES EACH

STEP 1 · SEE

what picture do you see?

STEP 2 · HEAR

what sound word does the poet use?

STEP 3 · FEEL

what feeling does the weather give?

What is the SAME about how both poets help us notice weather?

Q5 Reflection DOK 4

Essential Question: How does weather affect us? Use ideas from TWO of the texts you read in this module.

TWO-TEXT SYNTHESIS

TEXT 1 · TITLE & AUTHOR

How does weather affect the people, animals, or feelings in this text?

TEXT 2 · TITLE & AUTHOR

How does weather affect the people, animals, or feelings in this text?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 6 · Weather Wise · Grade 2

MAP RIT 180 → 200 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Day the Rain Came

Mina had waited all week for the school picnic. On Monday she packed a sandwich. On Tuesday she packed a snack. On Wednesday she packed juice. On Thursday she set out her hat. On Friday, she woke up and ran to the window. The sky was gray. Big drops of rain were tapping on the glass. Mina's heart sank. Her mom came in and smiled. "The picnic is moved to the gym. Mr. Han said we will eat together inside." Mina put on her boots and ran out. The rain made puddles. The puddles made small rivers. At the gym, the floor was warm and dry. The whole class ate together. Mina laughed. The rain did not ruin the day. The rain just changed it.

130 WORDS · LEXILE 240–290L · RIT 180–189

Q1 RIT 180 | Lexile 240L | Key Detail

What had Mina been waiting for all week?

- ○ **A.** A test at school.
- ○ **B.** Her birthday.
- ○ **C.** The school picnic.
- ○ **D.** A new puppy.

Q2 RIT 184 | Lexile 250L | Cause & Effect

Why did Mina's heart "sink" when she looked out the window?

- ○ **A.** Because the sky was gray and it was raining.
- ○ **B.** Because she lost her hat.
- ○ **C.** Because she was hungry.
- ○ **D.** Because her mom was upset.

Q3 RIT 186 | Lexile 260L | Inference

Why did Mr. Han move the picnic to the gym?

- ○ **A.** Because the rain made the outside wet and not safe for a picnic.
- ○ **B.** Because the gym was on fire.
- ○ **C.** Because the kids asked for indoor games.
- ○ **D.** Because the food was too cold.

Q4 RIT 188 | Lexile 270L | Vocabulary

"The rain did not ruin the day. The rain just changed it." This means —

- ○ **A.** Bad weather always makes a day bad.
- ○ **B.** Weather can change a plan, not destroy it — you can still have a good time.
- ○ **C.** The picnic was canceled forever.
- ○ **D.** Mina did not eat anything.

Q5 RIT 189 | Lexile 290L | Main Idea / Moral

How does weather AFFECT Mina and her class in this story?

- ○ **A.** It ruins the whole week and the picnic never happens at all.
- ○ **B.** It makes the whole class too sad to eat their lunch together.
- ○ **C.** It changes WHERE they eat — but they still have fun together.
- ○ **D.** It keeps everyone stuck at the window watching the rain all day.

Passage 2 · The Snow Plan

Ben's grandpa lived on a farm. Every winter, the snow came hard and fast. Grandpa always had a plan. Before the first snow, he checked the wood for the fireplace. He brought extra food in from the shed. He filled big jugs with water. He parked the truck close to the barn. "Why so much, Grandpa?" Ben asked one year. Grandpa smiled. "A blizzard can come for days. The road can close. The power can go out. I do not want to be scared. I want to be ready." That winter, a big blizzard came. The road did close. The power did go out. But Grandpa lit the fire. He pulled out the food. He read books with Ben by the light. Ben learned that getting ready turns a scary storm into a small adventure.

135 WORDS · LEXILE 300–350L · RIT 190–195

Q6 RIT 190 | Lexile 300L | Key Detail

Where did Ben's grandpa live?

- A. In a big city.
- B. By the ocean.
- C. On a farm.
- D. In an apartment.

Q7 RIT 192 | Lexile 320L | Cause & Effect

Why did Grandpa fill big jugs with water before the snow came?

- A. Because the power could go out and water would be hard to get.
- B. Because he wanted to wash the truck.
- C. Because the well was on fire.
- D. Because Ben asked him to.

Q8 RIT 193 | Lexile 330L | Vocabulary

In the passage, "I do not want to be scared. I want to be ready" most likely means Grandpa —

- A. hides under the bed during storms.
- B. stops storms by being calm.
- C. wants Ben to feel scared, too.
- D. chooses to prepare ahead of time, so a storm does not feel as scary.

Q9 RIT 194 | Lexile 340L | Inference

Why was the blizzard a "small adventure" instead of a scary storm?

- A. Because the snow stopped on the first day.
- B. Because Grandpa had food, fire, and books ready — they had everything they needed.
- C. Because Ben loved snow more than summer.
- D. Because the truck drove them away.

Q10 RIT 195 | Lexile 350L | Main Idea / Moral

How does WEATHER affect Grandpa and Ben in this passage?

- A. It does not affect them at all, because the blizzard never really comes.
- B. It makes Grandpa and Ben angry at each other while the snow falls.
- C. It pushes them to GET READY — and that turns a scary storm into a calm time together.
- D. It forces them to leave the farm and drive away in the truck.

Passage 3 · How Farmers Read the Sky

Long before TV news, farmers read the sky to plan their work. They watched the clouds. They watched the wind. They watched the way the cows lay down. A red sky at night was a good sign — clear weather was coming. A red sky in the morning was a warning — a storm might come. If the wind blew from the west, the day might be cool and dry. If the wind blew from the south, warm rain might come. Today, meteorologists use machines to predict the weather. But many farmers still look up. They know that weather is the boss of a farm. The temperature tells them when to plant. The rain tells them when to harvest. The climate, year after year, shapes what crops will grow at all.

135 WORDS · LEXILE 360–410L · RIT 195–199

Q11 RIT 195 Lexile 360L Key Detail

Before TV news, how did farmers plan their work?

- ○ **A.** They called the meteorologist on the phone.
- ○ **B.** They read the sky — the clouds, the wind, even the cows.
- ○ **C.** They flipped a coin.
- ○ **D.** They asked the city mayor.

Q12 RIT 196 Lexile 370L Cause & Effect

What did a "red sky in the morning" warn farmers about?

- ○ **A.** A drought would last a year.
- ○ **B.** Snow would fall in summer.
- ○ **C.** A storm might come.
- ○ **D.** The cows would run away.

Q13 RIT 197 Lexile 380L Inference

Why do farmers say that weather is "the boss" of a farm?

- ○ **A.** Because weather decides when to plant, when to harvest, and even what crops can grow.
- ○ **B.** Because the weather pays the farmer's bills.
- ○ **C.** Because farmers do not really care about weather.
- ○ **D.** Because clouds give orders out loud.

Q14 RIT 198 | Lexile 390L | Vocabulary

In the passage, "climate, year after year, shapes what crops will grow" most likely means —

- ○ **A.** Climate is a kind of tool.
- ○ **B.** Climate is the normal weather over many years — and it decides which crops the land can grow.
- ○ **C.** Crops shape the weather.
- ○ **D.** Farmers grow whatever they like, no matter the climate.

Q15 RIT 199 | Lexile 410L | Main Idea / Moral

How does weather AFFECT farmers, according to this passage?

- ○ **A.** It decides almost everything — when they plant, when they harvest, and what they can grow.
- ○ **B.** It only affects the cows, and never changes the farmer's own work.
- ○ **C.** It does not really affect the work now that machines do the planting.
- ○ **D.** It only matters in winter, when snow falls on the fields.

Passage 4 · The Storm Walker

Dr. Reed is a storm chaser. She drives a special truck toward storms — not away from them. Most people stay home when a tornado warning comes. Dr. Reed drives closer. She is not silly. She is careful. Her truck has thick glass. Her phone shows live radar. She also wears a helmet. Why does she do it? "Because the more we learn, the more lives we save," she says. Last spring, Dr. Reed and her team drove near a tornado in Kansas. They sent live data back to other meteorologists. That data helped a small town get a warning forty minutes earlier than usual. People had time to go to shelters. No one was hurt. The next morning, Dr. Reed drank coffee in a diner. A boy asked her, "Were you scared?" "Yes," she said. "But helping is bigger than being scared."

145 WORDS · LEXILE 440–500L · RIT 199–200

Q16 RIT 199 | Lexile 440L | Key Detail

What is Dr. Reed's job?

- ○ **A.** A school teacher.
- ○ **B.** A storm chaser — she drives toward storms to study them.
- ○ **C.** A bus driver.
- ○ **D.** A doctor for animals.

Q17 RIT 200 | Lexile 460L | Cause & Effect

Why did the small town in Kansas get a warning forty minutes earlier than usual?

- A. Because Dr. Reed's team sent live data back to other meteorologists.
- B. Because the wind blew the warning bell.
- C. Because the town had no school that day.
- D. Because the radio broke.

Q18 RIT 200 | Lexile 480L | Vocabulary

"She is not silly. She is careful." This means Dr. Reed —

- A. takes big risks for no reason.
- B. is afraid of small things.
- C. plans, uses safety gear, and chooses brave actions for a clear reason.
- D. drives slowly because she is sleepy.

Q19 RIT 200 | Lexile 490L | Inference

What does Dr. Reed mean by "helping is bigger than being scared"?

- A. She is never scared at all.
- B. Storms cannot hurt people.
- C. She IS scared sometimes, but saving lives matters more than the fear.
- D. Big things are always more important than small things.

Q20 RIT 200 | Lexile 500L | Main Idea / Moral

How does weather affect people, according to this passage?

- A. Weather can be dangerous — but when people study it carefully, warnings can save lives.
- B. Weather only affects farmers, so towns and families do not need to worry.
- C. Weather does not affect small towns, even when a tornado is coming.
- D. Weather is the same in every season, so no one needs a warning.